Understanding the CompTIA SecAI+ Certification

What CompTIA SecAI+ Is and Why It Was Created

CompTIA SecAI+ is a vendor-neutral, globally recognised certification that validates the knowledge and skills required to secure artificial intelligence systems across their full lifecycle — from design and data collection through model training, deployment, monitoring, and decommissioning. Launched in 2026, it is the first major vendor-neutral certification to address AI security as a distinct discipline rather than a subset of general cybersecurity or AI competency.

CompTIA created SecAI+ in response to a documented and growing gap: organisations were deploying AI systems at scale while their security teams lacked the training to secure those systems. This mirrors the dynamic that drove CompTIA to create Security+ in 2002 when network security expertise was scarce relative to the explosion in internet-connected systems.

Vendor neutrality is a critical feature. Unlike AWS Security Specialty (AWS-specific) or Google Professional Cloud Security Engineer (Google Cloud-specific), SecAI+ applies across cloud providers, on-premise deployments, hybrid environments, and any AI framework or platform. This portability makes it more broadly valuable across employers and more resilient to technology transitions.

The AI Security Skills Gap: Data and Implications

The credential's market value is directly tied to the gap between demand for AI security expertise and available supply. Several independent research sources converge on the same conclusion: this gap is severe and widening.

Data Point	Source	What It Means for Certification Value
89% of organisations report lacking sufficient AI security expertise	ISC2, 2025	Employers must compete aggressively for certified talent; premium salaries result
70% of enterprises have deployed AI in production	McKinsey Global Survey, 2026	The attack surface is large and growing; demand for defenders is structural, not cyclical
AI security roles grew 45% year-over-year in 2025	LinkedIn Economic Graph, 2025	Supply of practitioners is not keeping pace; early career entrants face low competition
Job postings for AI security roles increased 200% between 2023 and 2025	Indeed Hiring Lab, 2025	Employers are moving from preferred to required for AI security skills
78% of organisations experienced AI-related security incidents in 2024	Forrester Research, 2025	Demand is driven by proven real-world risk, not speculation about future threats
AI security identified as top-10 critical skills shortfall 2025 to 2030	World Economic Forum, 2025	Long-term structural demand; not a temporary trend tied to a single technology cycle

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SecAI+ Career Roles: Responsibilities and Salaries

The certification opens pathways to several distinct role families, each with different primary responsibilities, typical reporting structures, and required adjacent skills.

Role Title	Primary Responsibilities	Key Adjacent Skills	Salary Range (US, 2026)
AI Security Analyst	Monitor AI systems for anomalous behaviour; investigate AI-specific alerts; conduct model behaviour testing; document incidents	SIEM tools, Python scripting, ML model evaluation	$95,000 to $130,000
AI Risk Manager	Assess AI system risks against business context; quantify AI-specific risk; advise on risk treatment; report to executive leadership	Enterprise risk frameworks, AI regulatory knowledge, executive communication	$110,000 to $150,000
AI Governance Engineer	Implement AI policy frameworks; conduct model audits; assess bias and fairness; ensure EU AI Act and internal policy compliance	EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, ISO 42001, bias testing tools	$100,000 to $140,000
AI Security Architect	Design security controls for AI systems; establish MLSecOps pipelines; define AI security standards and reference architectures	Cloud security, DevSecOps, ML engineering, enterprise architecture	$130,000 to $180,000
AI Red Team Lead	Conduct adversarial testing of AI systems; develop novel attack techniques; communicate vulnerabilities to engineering and leadership	Adversarial ML, penetration testing, LLM attack research, report writing	$140,000 to $190,000

Exam Format and Structure: What to Expect

Understanding the exam format allows candidates to prepare specifically for the test experience, not just the content. SecAI+ follows CompTIA's standard exam structure with elements specific to a performance-based credential.

- Question types: The exam includes multiple-choice questions (single answer), multiple-select questions (select all that apply, often two or three correct answers), and performance-based questions (PBQs) that present interactive scenarios requiring the candidate to complete tasks such as identifying attack vectors in a presented AI system diagram or classifying model outputs.

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- Scoring: CompTIA uses a scaled scoring system from 100 to 900, with the passing score set at 750. This is not a simple percentage — the difficulty level of each question is factored into the scaled score.
- Time limit: Candidates receive 90 minutes to complete all questions. Performance-based questions appear at the beginning of the exam and typically take 5 to 10 minutes each, so time management is important.
- Delivery: The exam can be taken at a CompTIA testing centre or via online proctoring from any location with a sufficiently stable internet connection and a private environment.
- Retake policy: CompTIA's current policy allows an unlimited number of retakes with no waiting period after the first attempt, but candidates who fail a second time must wait 14 days before each subsequent attempt.

Prerequisites in Detail: What You Actually Need

CompTIA's stated recommendation (not requirement) for SecAI+ is 3 to 5 years of IT security or AI experience, plus Security+ certification or equivalent knowledge, plus foundational AI and ML understanding. Breaking this down in practice:

Recommended Background	What This Actually Means	How This Course Addresses It
3 to 5 years IT or security experience	Familiarity with core security concepts: CIA triad, network security, identity management, incident response basics	Security concepts introduced in context throughout all sections
Security+ or equivalent	Understanding of threat categories, security architecture principles, risk management, cryptography basics	Relevant security concepts reinforced throughout; no separate Security+ prep required
Basic AI and ML understanding	Awareness that ML involves training on data to produce models used for inference; familiarity with terms like neural network, supervised learning, model accuracy	Sections 2 to 4 cover all required AI fundamentals from first principles

The most important prerequisite is motivation and study consistency, not prior credentials. Candidates who study systematically over 2 to 8 months depending on starting background consistently pass SecAI+ without meeting the recommended experience level.

Industry Recognition: Who Values SecAI+

CompTIA certifications are recognised across a broad range of employer categories. SecAI+ is positioned to follow the recognition trajectory of Security+ and CySA+, which took 3 to 5 years after launch to become de facto requirements in job postings.

Employer Category	How They Value SecAI+	Expected Timeline to

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		Requirement
US Federal Government and Defence Contractors	CompTIA certifications are approved under DoD Directive 8570/8140; SecAI+ likely to be added as AI systems proliferate in defence contexts	2025 to 2027 for inclusion in approved baseline lists
Big Tech (Google, Microsoft, Amazon, Meta)	Early adopters building AI security teams; recognise vendor-neutral credentials for cross-platform security roles	Already valuing as of 2026 launch; job postings expected to cite by 2027
Financial Services (Goldman Sachs, JP Morgan)	Heavy AI deployment in trading, fraud detection, and customer service; regulatory pressure from SEC and FINRA driving formalisation	Formal requirements expected 2026 to 2028 as AI regulations mature
Healthcare (Mayo Clinic, Epic, payers)	FDA oversight of AI in medical devices; HIPAA implications for patient data in AI training sets	Certification requirements likely tied to FDA AI/ML guidance implementation timeline
Consulting (Deloitte, PwC, Accenture)	Client-facing AI security advisory practices; certifications validate practitioner expertise for client engagements	Already listing in preferred qualifications; likely required for senior practitioners by 2027

Real-World Application — EU AI Act Compliance Hiring Wave (2024 to 2026): Following the EU AI Act entering into force in August 2024, large organisations began hiring AI governance and compliance specialists at scale. Professionals who already held credentials validating AI governance expertise had a significant advantage in this hiring wave. SecAI+'s Domain 4 directly maps to the knowledge required for these roles.

Certification Validity, Renewal, and Continuing Education

SecAI+ is valid for three years from the date of passing. Renewal is achieved through CompTIA's Continuing Education (CE) programme, not by retaking the exam. This structure keeps certified professionals engaged with the evolving field.

30 CEUs are required over three years. Activities that earn CEUs include:

- Passing a higher-level CompTIA exam such as CASP+: earns all 30 CEUs at once
- Completing industry training and college courses: 1 CEU per instructional hour, up to 10 CEUs per activity
- Attending conferences, webinars, and symposia: 1 CEU per instructional hour, up to 10 CEUs per year
- Participating in CompTIA continuing education activities such as approved vendor training: up to 5 CEUs per activity
- Publishing articles, blogs, or books on AI security topics: up to 5 CEUs per publication

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- Documenting AI security work experience: up to 10 CEUs for verified professional experience

Comparing SecAI+ to Adjacent Credentials

Candidates often ask how SecAI+ relates to other certifications. The answer depends on their career goals and existing credential portfolio.

Certification	Issuer	Focus	Relationship to SecAI+	Who Should Stack It
Security+	CompTIA	General cybersecurity fundamentals	Complementary foundation; covers security basics that SecAI+ builds upon	Anyone without a security background pursuing SecAI+
CySA+	CompTIA	Cybersecurity analyst skills and threat detection	Complementary operational skills; combined portfolio covers traditional and AI security operations	SOC analysts and threat hunters adding AI focus
CISSP	ISC2	Broad security management and architecture across 8 domains	SecAI+ provides AI-specific depth that CISSP's broad coverage lacks	Senior security architects and managers who need AI security depth
AWS Security Specialty	Amazon	Security on AWS platform specifically	Platform-specific vs. vendor-neutral; complementary if working in AWS environments	Cloud engineers working with AI on AWS
ISO 42001 Lead Implementer	Various training providers	AI management system implementation	Narrow framework focus vs. SecAI+'s broader scope; useful for governance specialists	GRC professionals who want framework-specific certification alongside SecAI+

Planning Your Post-Certification Career Development

SecAI+ is a career foundation, not a career destination. Professionals who maximise its value combine the certification with deliberate experience accumulation and continuing skill development.

- Build practical experience during study: Set up home lab environments with open-source ML frameworks such as PyTorch and scikit-learn. Experiment with adversarial attack libraries such as Foolbox and the Adversarial Robustness Toolbox (ART). Documented hands-on experience amplifies the credential's interview value.
- Engage with the AI security research community: Follow AI safety and AI security researchers on academic publishing platforms such as arXiv. Organisations like MITRE (ATLAS framework for AI attacks), OWASP (ML Security Top 10), and NIST AI RMF working groups publish freely accessible resources.
- Target your first post-certification role strategically: Entry-level AI security roles often emerge as specialised functions within existing security operations teams. AI Security Analyst roles in financial

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services and healthcare tend to offer the best salary and learning opportunities for early-career professionals.

- Plan your next credential: The natural progression from SecAI+ depends on your specialisation. Red teamers might pursue OSCP plus adversarial ML research. Governance specialists might pursue ISO 42001 Lead Implementer. Architects might pursue CISSP or a cloud provider's security architect certification.

Key Terms Glossary

Term	Definition
Vendor Neutrality	Certification or standard that applies across products, platforms, and providers rather than being specific to one vendor's technology
DoD Directive 8570/8140	US Department of Defense policy mandating that certain IT and security personnel hold approved baseline certifications; CompTIA certifications are included
Scaled Scoring	Exam scoring method that adjusts for question difficulty; a 750 scaled score corresponds to the passing threshold regardless of total question count or difficulty distribution
Performance-Based Question (PBQ)	Exam item that requires completing an interactive task rather than selecting a text answer; tests applied knowledge
Continuing Education Units (CEUs)	Credits earned through approved professional development activities used to renew a CompTIA certification without retaking the exam
EU AI Act	EU regulation in force August 2024 classifying AI systems by risk level and imposing compliance obligations on deployers and providers of high-risk AI
NIST AI RMF	NIST's voluntary AI Risk Management Framework providing structured guidance for identifying, measuring, and managing AI risks
ISO 42001	International standard for AI management systems; provides requirements and guidance for responsible AI development and deployment
MLSecOps	Integration of security practices into the ML development and operations pipeline; analogous to DevSecOps for AI workloads
Adversarial Robustness Toolbox (ART)	Open-source Python library providing tools for adversarial attack and defence in ML systems; widely used in AI security research and practice
MITRE ATLAS	MITRE's Adversarial Threat Landscape for AI Systems; a knowledge base of adversarial tactics and techniques targeting ML systems
AI Skills Gap	The documented shortfall between organisational demand for AI security expertise and the available supply of trained practitioners

Quick Revision Checklist

- I can explain what CompTIA SecAI+ is and why it was created in 2026
- I understand what vendor neutrality means and why it makes SecAI+ more broadly valuable than platform-specific certifications

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- I know the key statistics describing the AI security skills gap and can explain what they mean for certification value
- I can describe at least four AI security career roles, their primary responsibilities, and approximate salary ranges
- I understand the SecAI+ exam format including question types, scoring method, time limit, and retake policy
- I know CompTIA's recommended prerequisites and what they actually mean for candidates from different backgrounds
- I can name at least three categories of employers that recognise or are expected to require SecAI+
- I understand the three-year validity period and the CEU-based renewal process
- I can position SecAI+ relative to adjacent credentials such as Security+, CISSP, and AWS Security Specialty
- I have a plan for building practical AI security skills during and after my certification preparation

20 Exam-Based MCQs — Understanding the CompTIA SecAI+ Certification

Test yourself after reading. These questions are written in real exam style — scenario-heavy, with plausible distractors. Read every explanation, including for questions you answered correctly.

Q1. What does vendor neutrality mean in the context of CompTIA SecAI+, and why is it significant for a security practitioner's career?

A. CompTIA does not accept payment from technology vendors for exam question development

B. The certification validates skills that apply across all AI platforms and cloud providers, making it portable and valuable regardless of which technology an employer uses

C. CompTIA certifications do not include questions about specific vendor products

D. Vendor neutrality means the certification is free of charge for all candidates

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Vendor neutrality means the certified knowledge applies universally across AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, on-premise, and any AI framework. This is distinct from platform-specific certifications such as AWS Security Specialty which is limited to AWS-specific knowledge. Platform-specific certifications may restrict career portability if an employer changes platforms or uses multiple cloud providers.

Q2. CompTIA SecAI+ uses a scaled scoring system with a passing threshold of 750. If two candidates answer the same number of questions correctly but one answered harder questions, what is the MOST likely outcome?

A. Both candidates receive the same score because total correct answers are equal

B. The candidate who answered harder questions receives a higher scaled score because harder questions are weighted more heavily

C. The candidate who answered easier questions receives a higher score because answering them faster allows more review time

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D. Both candidates fail because the exam requires all questions to be answered correctly

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Scaled scoring adjusts for question difficulty, meaning that correctly answering harder questions earns more credit toward the 750 passing threshold. This is why CompTIA reports scaled scores from 100 to 900 rather than raw percentages — two candidates with the same percentage correct can receive different scaled scores based on the difficulty distribution of questions they answered.

Q3. According to the course, what percentage of organisations experienced AI-related security incidents in 2024?

A. 45%

B. 70%

C. 78%

D. 89%

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct: 78% of organisations experienced AI-related security incidents in 2024 according to Forrester Research. The 89% figure refers to the percentage of organisations lacking sufficient AI security expertise (ISC2). The 70% figure refers to enterprises that have deployed AI in production (McKinsey). The 45% figure refers to the annual growth rate of AI security job postings (LinkedIn). Each statistic comes from a different research source.

Q4. A candidate fails the SecAI+ exam on their first attempt. According to CompTIA's retake policy, what must they do before their second attempt?

A. Wait 30 days before retaking

B. Complete an additional 20 hours of approved training before retaking

C. They may retake immediately with no waiting period after the first failure

D. Wait 90 days and provide evidence of additional study to CompTIA

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct: CompTIA's current policy allows candidates to retake the exam without a waiting period after their first failed attempt. The 14-day waiting period applies only from the third attempt onwards. There is no mandatory training requirement, no 30-day waiting period, and no 90-day waiting period after a first failure. Candidates should verify current policy directly with CompTIA before scheduling.

Q5. Which of the following BEST describes the relationship between SecAI+ and CompTIA Security+ for a cybersecurity professional?

A. They are equivalent credentials at the same level; earning one eliminates the need for the other

B. Security+ covers general cybersecurity fundamentals that SecAI+ builds upon; together they provide complementary coverage of traditional and AI security

C. SecAI+ replaces Security+ as the new baseline cybersecurity credential for all IT professionals

D. Security+ must be earned before SecAI+ as a mandatory prerequisite

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Security+ and SecAI+ are complementary credentials at different levels

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of specialisation. Security+ provides foundational cybersecurity knowledge that creates context for SecAI+'s AI-specific content. Together, they validate both foundational security knowledge and AI security specialisation. They are not equivalent or interchangeable. SecAI+ does not replace Security+. Security+ is a recommendation, not a mandatory prerequisite.

Q6. Why do performance-based questions (PBQs) appear at the BEGINNING of the SecAI+ exam rather than at the end?

A. CompTIA randomises question order, so PBQs do not consistently appear first

B. PBQs are worth more points, so completing them first maximises score potential

C. PBQs require more time and cognitive effort; candidates perform better on them when not fatigued from extended multiple-choice sections

D. PBQs contain answers to multiple-choice questions, so they must be completed first

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct: Performance-based questions require active problem-solving in interactive scenarios and typically take 5 to 10 minutes each. Placing them at the beginning ensures candidates attempt them when their mental energy is highest, rather than rushing through them after 60 minutes of multiple-choice questions. PBQs are placed intentionally, not randomly. They are not specifically higher-weighted per question and do not contain answers to other questions.

Q7. A UK-based financial services company is hiring an AI Governance Engineer to ensure compliance with the EU AI Act. Which combination of credentials MOST directly validates the applicant's relevant competencies?

A. AWS Security Specialty + Certified Data Privacy Solutions Engineer (CDPSE)

B. CompTIA SecAI+ + ISO 42001 Lead Implementer training

C. CISSP + Certified Information Privacy Professional (CIPP/E)

D. Google Professional Cloud Security Engineer + CompTIA Security+

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: SecAI+'s Domain 4 directly covers AI governance frameworks including the EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, and AI risk management. ISO 42001 Lead Implementer training provides specific competency in implementing an AI management system, which is directly relevant to EU AI Act compliance. The other combinations focus on general security, cloud platforms, or data privacy — relevant but not as directly targeted to AI governance.

Q8. According to the course, what CEU activity earns the maximum number of CEUs at once for SecAI+ renewal?

A. Attending a major AI security conference for three days

B. Publishing an article about prompt injection defences

C. Passing a higher-level CompTIA exam such as CASP+, earning all 30 required CEUs at once

D. Completing 10 hours of approved vendor training

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct: Passing a higher-level CompTIA exam earns all 30 required CEUs simultaneously, completing the entire renewal requirement in a single activity. This is the most efficient

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renewal path for candidates who intend to advance their certification level. Conference attendance earns 1 CEU per instructional hour with a 10 CEU annual cap. Publishing earns up to 5 CEUs per publication. Vendor training earns up to 10 CEUs per activity. None of these individually fulfil the full 30 CEU requirement.

Q9. MITRE ATLAS is mentioned as a resource for AI security practitioners. How does it relate to MITRE ATT&CK?

A. ATLAS replaces ATT&CK for organisations that have deployed AI systems

B. ATLAS is a knowledge base of adversarial tactics and techniques specifically targeting ML systems, analogous to how ATT&CK catalogues tactics for traditional IT systems

C. ATLAS is a CompTIA-approved supplement to the SecAI+ exam preparation materials

D. ATLAS and ATT&CK are identical frameworks applied to different technology contexts

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: MITRE ATLAS (Adversarial Threat Landscape for AI Systems) extends the ATT&CK model specifically to ML systems, cataloguing techniques such as model evasion, adversarial ML, and AI supply chain compromises. It provides a structured taxonomy for describing AI-specific attack techniques. ATLAS supplements rather than replaces ATT&CK because many attacks on AI systems still involve traditional IT techniques. It is not a CompTIA product and is not identical to ATT&CK.

Q10. A data scientist with 3 years of ML engineering experience is evaluating whether to pursue SecAI+. Which statement about their exam preparation timeline is MOST accurate?

A. They need 5 to 8 months because they lack security experience and must build both domains from scratch

B. They need 2 to 3 months because they have a strong AI foundation and can focus primarily on security concepts

C. They need no preparation because ML engineers automatically possess the knowledge tested by SecAI+

D. They need 8 to 12 months because AI security is more complex than traditional ML engineering

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: A data scientist with ML engineering experience has strong coverage of Domain 1 (AI Fundamentals) and can apply that knowledge to understand Domain 3 attack techniques quickly. Their primary study investment should be in security operations, defensive controls, and governance frameworks. The 5 to 8 month timeline applies to career changers with no AI or security background. ML knowledge alone does not qualify someone for SecAI+ because security-specific knowledge must be tested.

Q11. The course notes that the window for early-adopter advantage in AI security is open right now. What economic mechanism makes early certification adoption disproportionately valuable?

A. CompTIA offers lower exam fees to early adopters of new certifications

B. When employer demand for a credential significantly exceeds certified practitioner supply, early adopters command premium compensation before supply catches up

C. Early adopters receive preferential treatment in CompTIA's job placement programme

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D. The exam is harder after the first year because CompTIA increases difficulty as the credential matures

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Credential value is determined by the ratio of employer demand to supply of certified professionals. When a new credential addresses a genuine and growing skill gap, early adopters enter the market before competition from other certified professionals emerges, allowing them to negotiate from a position of relative scarcity. As certification supply grows over years, competition increases and salary premiums moderate. CompTIA does not offer fee discounts, job placement programmes, or changing difficulty based on credential maturity.

Q12. A SecAI+ candidate is 6 weeks from their exam with strong Domain 3 knowledge but weak Domain 4 knowledge. How should they allocate their remaining study time?

A. Spend 38% of time on Domain 3 and 19% on Domain 4, matching exam weighting exactly

B. Spend the majority of remaining time on Domain 4, because that is the identified weakness — exam weighting guides balanced candidates, not targeted remediation

C. Focus equal time on all four domains regardless of existing knowledge gaps

D. Skip Domain 4 because its 19% weighting makes it less important than Domain 3

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Exam weighting guides proportional study allocation for a candidate starting from zero knowledge. For a candidate with identified weaknesses, the optimal strategy is to invest disproportionately in those weak areas. A candidate who fails Domain 4 questions loses 19% of their score potential, which could be the difference between passing and failing. Domain 3's 38% weighting is already strong, so marginal additional study there yields diminishing returns. Skipping Domain 4 sacrifices 19% of available points.

Q13. What does the Adversarial Robustness Toolbox (ART) enable security practitioners to do?

A. Assess employee resistance to social engineering attacks using AI-generated phishing simulations

B. Conduct adversarial attacks and test defensive measures against ML models in a controlled environment

C. Monitor AI model outputs in production for deviation from expected behaviour

D. Automate the EU AI Act risk classification process for deployed AI systems

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: The Adversarial Robustness Toolbox is an open-source Python library that implements adversarial attack algorithms and defences for ML models. It enables practitioners to assess how robust their models are to adversarial inputs and test the effectiveness of defensive measures. It is not a phishing simulation tool, a production monitoring tool, or a regulatory compliance tool.

Q14. Why is the three-year validity period of SecAI+ designed to require renewal through CEUs rather than retaking the exam?

A. Retaking the exam is too expensive for CompTIA to administer repeatedly

B. The CEU model ensures practitioners remain actively engaged with a rapidly evolving field, keeping certified knowledge current without the disruption of a full exam retake

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C. CompTIA lacks the capacity to update exam questions frequently enough to test current knowledge

D. CEU-based renewal is required by EU AI Act compliance provisions for AI security certifications

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: AI security is evolving faster than almost any other technology discipline — new attack techniques, regulatory frameworks, and defensive tools emerge continuously. The CEU model incentivises ongoing professional development through activities such as conference attendance, training, and publication, ensuring practitioners stay current rather than relying on three-year-old exam knowledge. Exam retakes would test a static snapshot; CEUs test engagement with a living field.

Q15. A hiring manager at a healthcare technology company is reviewing candidates for an AI Security Analyst role referencing FDA AI/ML guidance and HIPAA compliance. Which background BEST prepares a candidate for this specific role?

A. Traditional penetration tester plus Cloud Security Specialty certification

B. SecAI+ plus healthcare IT experience plus familiarity with FDA AI/ML Software as a Medical Device guidance

C. Data scientist plus CompTIA Security+ certification

D. Network engineer plus CISSP certification

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Healthcare AI security roles require the intersection of AI security knowledge (SecAI+), regulatory familiarity specific to healthcare (FDA SaMD guidance for AI-enabled medical devices, HIPAA for patient data in training sets), and healthcare IT experience. Generic penetration testing, data science, and network security credentials do not address the specific regulatory and domain knowledge the role requires.

Q16. What is the PRIMARY reason that companies like Google, Microsoft, and Amazon are described as early adopters of SecAI+ even before it created a large pool of certified candidates?

A. These companies helped fund the development of the SecAI+ exam and receive preferred hiring access

B. These companies are building AI security teams and recognise SecAI+ as a signal of structured AI security knowledge, even before it becomes a universal hiring requirement

C. CompTIA requires all technology companies to recognise SecAI+ under the US National Cybersecurity Workforce Framework

D. These companies receive discounts for candidate registrations as exam sponsors

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Large technology companies building dedicated AI security functions need to identify candidates with genuine AI security knowledge. SecAI+ provides a validated signal of structured preparation in a field where few other objective measures of competency exist. Early recognition by major employers creates positive feedback: more candidates pursue the cert, more employers require it, and the credential's value grows. There is no funding arrangement, legal requirement, or discount structure described.

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Q17. How does the 30 CEU requirement over three years translate to a practical minimum annual activity commitment?

A. Approximately 10 CEUs per year, achievable through around 10 hours of approved training annually

B. All 30 CEUs must be earned in the final year before expiry

C. CEUs can only be earned by attending CompTIA-sponsored events

D. The 30 CEU requirement resets each year, requiring 90 total CEUs over three years

Answer: A **Explanation:** Correct: Distributing the 30 CEU requirement over three years yields approximately 10 CEUs annually. A reasonable approach is 10 hours of approved training or 1 to 2 relevant conferences per year, combined with professional activities such as publishing or additional certifications. There is no requirement to earn all CEUs at the end. CEUs can be earned from a wide range of approved activities, not just CompTIA events. The 30 CEU requirement is a total for the three-year period, not a per-year requirement.

Q18. A senior GRC analyst holding CISSP and CIPP/E is evaluating SecAI+ as an addition to their credential portfolio. Which aspect of SecAI+ provides the GREATEST incremental value for their specific background?

A. Domain 1 (AI Fundamentals), because GRC analysts typically lack all AI knowledge

B. Domain 2 (AI Security Operations), because GRC analysts need SOC tool training

C. Domain 4 (Governance, Risk, and Compliance), because their existing credentials do not cover AI-specific regulatory frameworks like the EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, and ISO 42001

D. Domain 3 (AI Attack Vectors), because GRC analysts need to perform red team activities

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct: A CISSP plus CIPP/E holder has strong general security management and data privacy knowledge but neither credential covers AI-specific governance frameworks. SecAI+'s Domain 4 directly addresses this gap, enabling a GRC professional to extend their practice into AI governance advisory and compliance roles. Domain 1 has partial overlap with general data science knowledge many GRC analysts already have. Domain 2 is operational, not governance-focused. Domain 3 is offensive, not aligned with GRC work.

Q19. Which of the following BEST illustrates why building a home lab with adversarial ML tools during SecAI+ study adds career value beyond the certification itself?

A. Home lab experience earns CEUs before the certification is earned

B. Portfolio evidence of hands-on adversarial ML skills differentiates candidates in interviews and compensates for limited professional AI security work experience

C. CompTIA requires documented tool experience to validate exam registration

D. Home lab practice allows candidates to skip Domain 1 content

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: Entry-level AI security roles require experience that is hard to get without a role — a classic catch-22. Building a documented home lab practice with adversarial ML tools, AI security research replication, and write-ups of findings provides concrete interview evidence of genuine engagement that many candidates lack. This differentiates motivated self-learners from candidates who

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only studied for the exam. CEUs are not relevant before initial certification. CompTIA does not require documented tool experience for registration. Home lab does not replace Domain 1 study.

Q20. What is the PRIMARY career benefit of SecAI+ for a traditional penetration tester who already holds OSCP and CEH?

A. SecAI+ teaches penetration testing techniques that OSCP and CEH do not cover

B. SecAI+ adds AI-specific offensive and defensive knowledge, allowing the penetration tester to offer AI red teaming services — a rapidly growing and highly paid specialty that OSCP and CEH do not address

C. SecAI+ replaces OSCP and CEH as the preferred penetration testing credential

D. SecAI+ is required before a penetration tester can legally test AI systems in regulated industries

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct: OSCP and CEH validate traditional infrastructure and application penetration testing skills. Neither credential covers adversarial ML, prompt injection testing, model evasion techniques, or AI red teaming methodologies. SecAI+ fills this gap, allowing a penetration tester to offer AI-specific red teaming services — a specialty that commands premium day rates and is sought by organisations deploying AI at scale. SecAI+ does not teach traditional penetration testing (A), does not replace OSCP or CEH (C), and is not a legal requirement for testing AI systems (D).

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